

TUULI TÄHTINEN

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ifo Institute & University of Munich

Research Interests

Political Economy, Public Economics, Development Economics, Applied Microeconomics

Current Position and Affiliations

Postdoctoral Researcher, ifo Institute	Since 2023
Junior Faculty Member, Ludwig-Maximilians-University Munich, Department of Economics	Since 2023
Research Affiliate, CESifo Research Network	Since 2025

Education

PhD in Economics, European University Institute, Italy	2023
Visiting Doctoral Student, Aalto University, Finland	2022–2023
MRes in Economics, European University Institute, Italy	2018
Master of Social Sciences, Economics, University of Helsinki, Finland	2016

Research

Publications

“[Conflict and Democratic Preferences](#),” with Nicole Stoelinga. *World Development*, 202 (2026)

“[Populism and Ideological Convergence: Evidence from a Multiparty System](#),” *Journal of Public Economics*, 241 (2025)

“[When Facebook is the Internet: The Role of Social Media in Ethnic Conflict](#),” *World Development*, 180 (2024)

Working Papers

“[Female Leaders and the Representation of Women in Government](#),” with Luisa Dörr, Klaus Gründler and Niklas Potrafke. Reject & Resubmit at *American Economic Journal: Economic Policy*

“[Making the Cut: Close Elections and Local Welfare Policy](#),” with Nikolaj Broberg and Thomas Walsh. Revise & Resubmit at *European Economic Review*

Selected Work in Progress

“*Childhood Environment and Adult Political Behavior*,” with Aino Kalmbach and Liam Wren-Lewis

“*Hidden Military Financing*,” with Niklas Potrafke and Stefan Smutny

“*Do Firms Benefit from Political Connections?*,” with Tuomas Kari, Jeremias Nieminen, Janne Tukiainen and Juho Vesa

“*Business-Connected Politicians and Municipal Fiscal Policy: Evidence from Close Elections in Finland*,” with Lucas Braga de Melo, Tuomas Kari, Jeremias Nieminen, Janne Tukiainen and Juho Vesa

“*Democratic Complacency: Ethnic Representation and Political Engagement*,” with Nicole Stoelinga

Policy Papers

“*Geopolitical Risk, Defense Expenditure, and Economic Consequences: Assessments from Experts Around the World*,” with with Christian Gréus, Philipp Heil, Niklas Potrafke, and Ramona Schmid. Perspektiven der Wirtschaftspolitik. Available at: <https://doi.org/10.1515/pwp-2025-0038>. (in German)

“*The Economic Consequences of Tariffs and Trade Policy Uncertainty*,” with Christian Gréus, Philipp Heil, Niklas Potrafke, and Ramona Schmid. EconPol Policy Brief 79 (2025).

“*Economic Policy under Donald Trump: An Assessment by US Economic Experts*,” with Philipp Heil, Emilie Höslinger, Niklas Potrafke, and Emil Scholten. ifo Schnelldienst 9/2025. (in German)

“*What Do Economists Think About Tariffs? Insights from the Economic Experts Survey*,” with Philipp Heil, Emilie Höslinger, and Niklas Potrafke. EconPol Policy Brief 76:1–9 (2025).

“*German Public Opinion on Defense and the Bundeswehr*,” with Niklas Potrafke, Emil Scholten, and Konstantinos Theodoropoulos. EconPol Forum 26 (3):10–16 (2025).

“*Economic Experts Survey Q1 2024: Evaluating Global Economic Policy Worldwide*,” with Philipp Heil, Niklas Potrafke, and Timo Wochner. ifo Institut, Munich (2024).

“*What Policies Do Populists Pursue When in Power? Results of Selected Studies*,” with Luisa Dörr, Niklas Potrafke and Felix Rösel. EconPol Forum 25 (2):29–31 (2024).

“*Profitability, competition, and development needs in the private rental housing market*,” with Eeva Alho, Valtteri Härmälä, Antti Kekäläinen, Kirsi Noro and Lauri Vuori. Publications of the Government’s analysis, assessment and research activities 9/2018. (in Finnish)

“*Immigrants on the Labour Market – A Study of the Working Lives of Immigrants Arriving in Finland in Different Years*,” with Henna Busk, Signe Jauhiainen, Antti Kekäläinen and Satu Nivalainen. Finnish Centre for Pensions, Studies 6/2016. (in Finnish)

“*Patient Freedom of Choice, the Swedish Model and Finland’s Health and Social Services Reform – From the Point of View of Functionality of the Markets and Economic Effects*,” with Ari Ahonen and Liisa Vuorio. Publications of the Finnish Competition and Consumer Authority 6/2015. (in Finnish)

Professional Activities

Referee:

CESifo Economic Studies, Economica, European Economic Review, European Journal of Political Economy, Frontiers in Political Science, Journal of European Economic Association, Journal of Institutional and Theoretical Economics, Scandinavian Journal of Economics, Women’s Studies International Forum

Seminar and conference organization:

CEMIR Junior Workshop on Migration Research (2026)
 CESifo Area Conference on Public Economics (2025, 2026)
 ifo Lunchtime Seminar (2024–2025)
 ifo Christmas Conference (2024, 2025)
 Development Economics PhD Workshop at UNU-WIDER (2022)

Grants and Awards

Bridge Project, ifo Institute. “How do countries finance increases in military spending”	2025–2026
ifo Outstanding Publication Award	2025
ifo Transfer Prize	2025
Oskar Öflund Foundation, Research grant	2025
TelepART Mobility Support	2023
European University Institute, PhD Completion Grant	2020–2021
Academy of Finland, PhD Scholarship	2017–2023

Conferences and Seminars

2026: Silvaplana Political Economy Workshop (scheduled); Peace, Conflict and the Economy Workshop (scheduled); Workshop on Revolving Doors, Corporate Political Connections, and Lobbying; EPCS; Helsinki GSE

2025: University of Siegen; Silvaplana Political Economy Workshop; EUI Alumni Conference; CESifo Area Conference on Public Economics; Kiel University; Finnish Economic Association

2024: ifo Institute; IIPF; Silvaplana Political Economy Workshop; NICEP; Conference on the Political Economy of Democracy and Dictatorship (PEDD)

2023: UniBZ Political Economy Workshop; LMU Munich; Silvaplana Political Economy Workshop; ZEW-ifo Young Scholar Political Economy Workshop; ifo Institute; Helsinki GSE; MPSA Annual Conference; ETLA

2022: Helsinki Development Economics PhD Workshop; Helsinki GSE; EUI

2021: EALE Annual Conference; EEA-ESEM; International Association for Applied Econometrics (IAAE); International Conference on European Studies; Swiss Society of Economics and Statistics; French Economic Association; XXIII Applied Economics Meeting; Canadian Economics Association; QMUL Economics and Finance Workshop for PhD & Post-doctoral Students; European Meeting of the Urban Economics Association; Scottish Economic Society; European Public Choice Society; ETH Zurich; RGS Doctoral Conference in Economics

Teaching

Seminar “Topics in Political Economy”, (MSc), LMU Munich	Winter 2025–2026
Seminar “Topics in Political Economy”, (MSc), LMU Munich	Summer 2025
Seminar “Empirical Political Economy”, (BSc), TA, LMU Munich	Winter 2023–2024
Supervision of Bachelor’s & Master’s theses, LMU Munich	Since 2023

Additional Training

Leibniz Leadership Academy: Starting Leadership, Leibniz Association	2026
Teach with Confidence: Strategies for Handling Challenging Situations, LMU Munich	2025
Introduction to Teaching in Higher Education, EUI	2021
Expertise in Russian and Eastern European Studies, University of Helsinki, Aleksanteri Institute	2013–2016
Student Exchange, Kazan (Volga region) Federal University, Russia	2014

Other Employment

Pellervo Economic Research PTT. Helsinki, Finland Economist	2016–2017
Finnish Competition and Consumer Authority. Helsinki, Finland Research Assistant	2015
VATT Institute for Economic Research. Helsinki, Finland Research Assistant	2014

Last updated: June, 2026